b. Diseases caused by Virus

Viral diseases are extremely widespread infections caused by many type of viruses. Some diseases caused by viruses are hepatitis, chickenpox and rabies.

1. Hepatitis

Hepatitis is one of the most dangerous and fatal diseases caused by Hepatitis virus- A, B, C, D, E. Its mode of transmission is contaminated water, sharing of needles and blood transfusion. The symptoms of hepatitis is loss of appetite (anorexia), vomiting, eyes and urine turning to yellow colour.

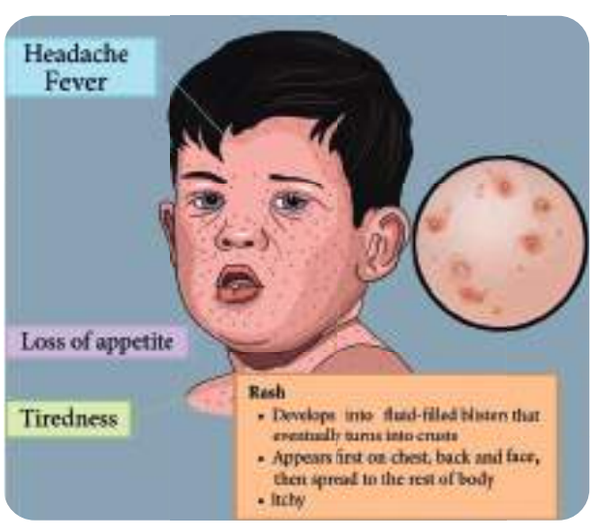


Prevention and treatment

- Drinking boiled water
- Proper cleaning of hands

2. Chickenpox

Chickenpox also known as varicella is a highly contagious infection caused by the varicella zoster virus. This disease spreads through air and contact with an infected person. Its symptoms are appearance of rashes on the whole body, fever, headache and tiredness.



Prevention and treatment

- The chickenpox (varicella) vaccine is the best way to prevent chickenpox
- Special attention should be given to the infected persons.

c. Rabies

Rabies is a fatal disease which is transmitted by the bite of the infected dog, rabbit, monkey, cat etc. The virus present in the saliva of dog enters the brain via neurons. The symptoms of rabies are hydrophobia (extreme fear for water), fever for 2 – 12 weeks and exaggerations in behaviour.

Prevention and treatment

- In early stages rabies is very difficult to detect.
- After an animal is bitten it usually takes two to twelve weeks to show any symptoms and it may take as long as two years also.
- Fatality can be prevented by timely vaccination before the onset of symptoms.

ACTIVITY 4

Visit a nearby Primary Health Centre and collect information about vaccination given to children of 0-15 years. Meet a doctor or a health worker in the hospital and enquire about the following.

- The types of vaccines available there.
- Can disease be prevented by their usage?
- The age at which it should be given.

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